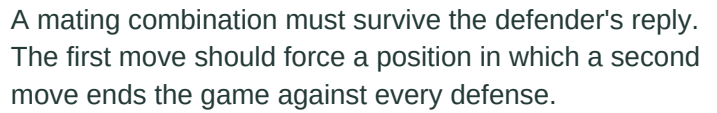


Mate in two

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

Previous move: 37...Rh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

38. Rf8+ Rxf8 39. Qxf8#

39.Qxf8# Mate: queen on f8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.